Training Evidence: Automatic Alerts

Installation and user guide for the Moodle plugin

Plugin · local_efalerts

Version 0.6.4 · Works with Moodle 5.1 to 5.3

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GUIDE

The tutor's assistant that never sleeps

Nobody finds out too late about something that could have been fixed in time, and good progress gets a word of praise too.

1 What it is and what it is for

Automatic Alerts checks every course once a day and warns the tutor, and the student too, when someone has not started, has dropped off or is going to miss the minimum requirements. It also congratulates students on their progress. This is the engagement role that any online training that has to be proven demands (in Spain, under the FUNDAE® training scheme), without relying on someone remembering to check.

> The key: real messages, real evidence
> The notices to the student are **real Moodle messages** sent in the tutor's name: they are recorded, the student can reply, and the Communications Report collects them as evidence of tutor engagement for an audit.

2 The five alerts

Alert	When it fires (defaults; everything is configurable)	Who receives it
Never started	2 days after THEIR enrolment without ever having logged in (never before the start of the training period)	tutor + student
Drop-off	5 days without logging back in; one extra reminder if they still do not return	tutor + student
Mid-course check	Halfway through the course dates, below 50% of the activities	tutor + student
Final stretch	7 days before the end date, failing any active criterion (§5)	tutor + student
Milestones	On reaching 25%, 50% and 75% of the activities (once per milestone)	student

Two more alerts, with the Training Evidence Report new

If you have the Training Evidence Report (local_efreport) installed, two more alerts appear in the alert settings of each course. They come **switched off**:

- **Assessments below the minimum**: from the midpoint of the training period, a message to any student who has completed fewer assessments than the course minimum (the 75% FUNDAE® requires, unless you change it in the Training Evidence Report). Sent once. Its template also accepts `{controles}` ("1/4") and `{umbral}`. Requires assessments to be enabled in that course.
- **Diploma deadline (for the tutor)**: FUNDAE® allows two months from the end of the training to issue the diploma or the attendance certificate. A few days before that deadline (10 by default), the tutor's daily email lists the students who are due a document and have not yet been issued one. Nothing is sent to the student. Requires certificates to be enabled in the Training Evidence Report.

3 Installation and site settings

1. Upload the ZIP in **Site administration → Plugins → Install plugins** and confirm.
2. In **Site administration → Plugins → Local plugins → Training Evidence: Automatic Alerts**, set the **Maximum emails per hour** to suit your hosting (with a limit of 100 per hour, use 90): deliveries trickle out through a queue that never exceeds it.
3. Check the integrity in **Site administration → Reports → System status**.

> **OFF BY DEFAULT**
>
> The plugin **does nothing** until a manager switches it on, course by course. No surprises.

4 Turning them on in a course

In the course: **More → Automatic Alerts** (with the Training Evidence Report installed, the entry is a card on the **Training Management** page).

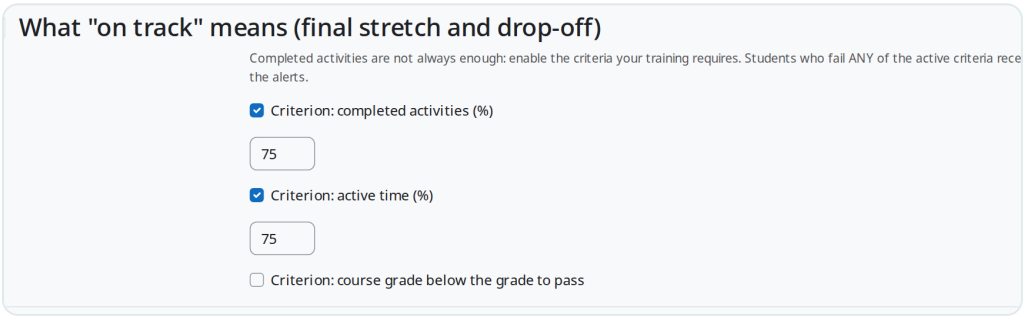


Tick **Enable alerts on this course**, choose the **Tutor who sends the messages** (or leave it on **Automatic (first editing teacher)**) and tick **which alerts** you want, with their days and thresholds.

- Each alert is switched on separately; the numbers (days, %) are tuned to the course: a short course calls for short thresholds.
- If the course has no dates, the mid-course check and the final stretch alert have no effect (the form tells you so).

5 What “on track” means (the criteria)

Completed activities are not always enough: your training may also require a grade or a minimum time. Anyone who fails **any** of the active criteria receives the drop-off alert and the final stretch alert; anyone who meets them all is left in peace.



Up to three criteria: **completed activities** (≥75%, the regulatory bar), **active time** (% of the course hours; requires the Training Evidence Report) and **course grade** against the grade to pass in the gradebook.

6 The messages to the student (templates)

Each alert comes with a well-written default text that you can customise per course, with placeholders that are filled in for each student:

Placeholder	Becomes…
{nombre}	The student's first name
{curso}	The course name
{diasinactivo}	Days since their last access
{porcentaje}	% of activities completed
{diasrestantes}	Days until the end of the course

EXAMPLE (DROP-OFF, DEFAULT TEXT)

"Hi Carlos, it has been 5 days since you last logged in to "Health and Safety at Work". There are 12 days left and you have completed 40% of the activities. If you are having trouble accessing or keeping up with the course, reply to this message and I will help you."

7 The tutor's daily email

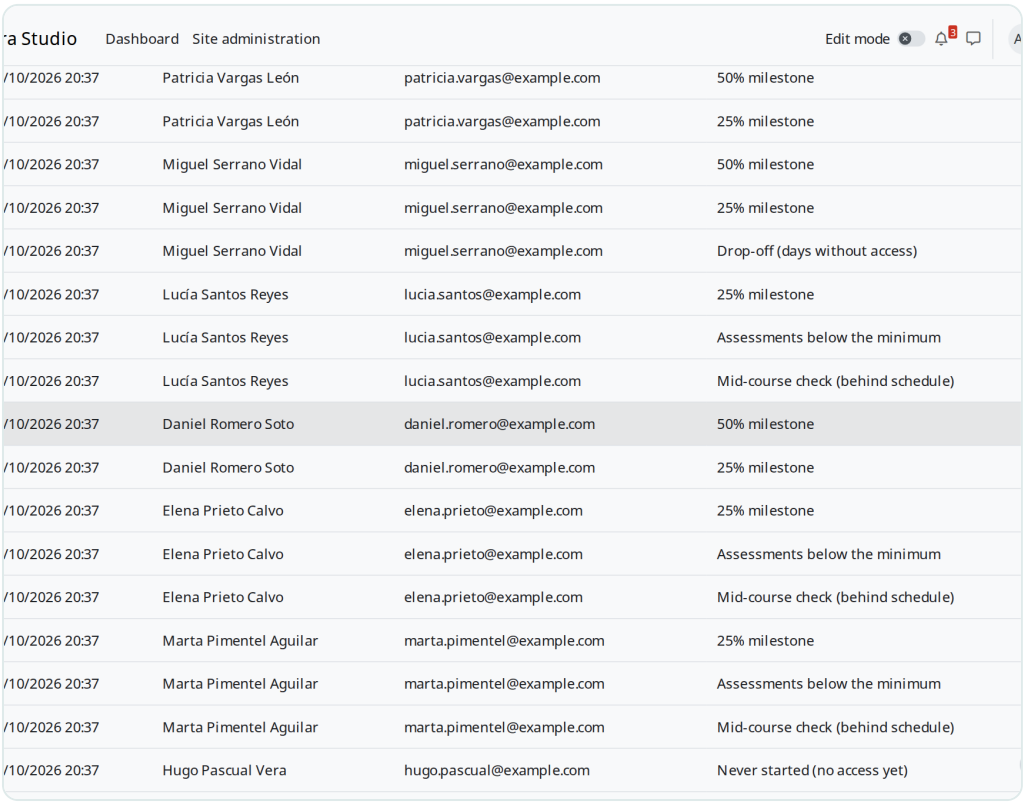
The tutor is not flooded with notices: they receive **one email a day per course** with a table for each type of alert, listing the first name, last name, email and status of every student affected, sorted by name. One read over coffee, then act.

WHEN IT IS EVALUATED

A scheduled task reviews the active courses **once a day** (at 6:00 by default; the administrator can change the time in the scheduled tasks). Deliveries go out afterwards, paced by the emails-per-hour cap.

8 The alert log

Below the course settings, the log records every alert issued: the evidence that the follow-up actually happened.



/10/2026 20:37	Patricia Vargas León	patricia.vargas@example.com	50% milestone
/10/2026 20:37	Patricia Vargas León	patricia.vargas@example.com	25% milestone
/10/2026 20:37	Miguel Serrano Vidal	miguel.serrano@example.com	50% milestone
/10/2026 20:37	Miguel Serrano Vidal	miguel.serrano@example.com	25% milestone
/10/2026 20:37	Miguel Serrano Vidal	miguel.serrano@example.com	Drop-off (days without access)
/10/2026 20:37	Lucía Santos Reyes	lucia.santos@example.com	25% milestone
/10/2026 20:37	Lucía Santos Reyes	lucia.santos@example.com	Assessments below the minimum
/10/2026 20:37	Lucía Santos Reyes	lucia.santos@example.com	Mid-course check (behind schedule)
/10/2026 20:37	Daniel Romero Soto	daniel.romero@example.com	50% milestone
/10/2026 20:37	Daniel Romero Soto	daniel.romero@example.com	25% milestone
/10/2026 20:37	Elena Prieto Calvo	elena.prieto@example.com	25% milestone
/10/2026 20:37	Elena Prieto Calvo	elena.prieto@example.com	Assessments below the minimum
/10/2026 20:37	Elena Prieto Calvo	elena.prieto@example.com	Mid-course check (behind schedule)
/10/2026 20:37	Marta Pimentel Aguilar	marta.pimentel@example.com	25% milestone
/10/2026 20:37	Marta Pimentel Aguilar	marta.pimentel@example.com	Assessments below the minimum
/10/2026 20:37	Marta Pimentel Aguilar	marta.pimentel@example.com	Mid-course check (behind schedule)
/10/2026 20:37	Hugo Pascual Vera	hugo.pascual@example.com	Never started (no access yet)

With **filters** (date, student, email, alert type), **sortable** columns (date, student, email), **Download CSV** honouring the filters, and pagination.

THE LOG ONLY SAYS WHAT HAPPENED

An alert enters the log when there is something to deliver (a message to the student or a line in the tutor's digest). With no tutor on the course nothing is logged; and if a message cannot be sent after three attempts, its entry **is withdrawn** and the rule tries again later. The body of the messages and digests (with names and email addresses) is deleted after 30 days: the log entry remains.

For a **new run** of the course (the same students again), use **Reset** on the course with the option "Reset all alerts (issued notices and pending messages)"; otherwise the one-off alerts (never started, mid-course, final stretch…) will not be repeated for anyone who has already received them. Deleting the course content does the same. When someone is unenrolled, their pending notices are cancelled and the log is kept.

9 Automatic exclusions

- **Suspended enrolments** receive nothing.
- Anyone who **meets all the active criteria** receives neither the drop-off nor the final stretch alert (even if they do not log in again: they have finished).
- Milestones are sent **once per milestone**; the drop-off alert respects its spacing and its cap on reminders.

- If site messaging is disabled, nothing is queued for the student (the tutor's digest still goes out).

10 Permissions

Capability	Who	What it allows
`local/efalerts:manage`	Editing teacher, manager	Configure the course alerts and view their log.

The student has no pages (they only receive messages). The **auditor needs nothing here**: the evidence they are interested in (the messages) is in the Communications Report.

11 Backups and integrity

- The **settings always travel** with the course backup (the chosen tutor is remapped; if they do not exist on the destination site, the setting falls back to automatic).
- The **alert log** travels with "Include course logs", without duplicates if you restore twice. The delivery queue does not travel (it is operational state).
- **Plugin file integrity** check in System status.

When a course is deleted (since version 0.2.0), the settings, the history and the alert queue for that course are removed automatically: a clean deletion, with no orphaned data left in the database.

12 Other eLearning Fácil plugins

Automatic Alerts is sold on its own and is also part of the **Training Evidence Pack**; it builds on what the Training Evidence Report measures. This is the family of eLearning Fácil plugins that work the same way, together or on their own:

Training Evidence Pack

Training evidence, ready for an audit. Training Evidence Report with a reliable clock (inactivity, period, 75% assessments), a report on communications with the tutor, a course dossier in a ZIP you can keep for as long as your scheme requires (4 years under Spain's FUNDAE® scheme), a block with links to the reports, and access to activities by time spent. With a group record for several training groups or companies in one course. elearningfacil.com/pack-fundae-moodle

Also in the Pack

Training Evidence: Automatic Alerts (`local_efalerts`) for the student and the tutor (never started, drop-off, final stretch, assessments, certificate deadline); **Training Evidence: Course Ready Check** (`local_efready`), which checks the course meets the requirements before it starts; and **Training Evidence: My Progress** (`block_efprogress` , free), the block where each student sees their time and what is left.

Class Manager

Sell courses by seat and rent out classrooms on your Moodle. Your client enrols their own students from their course; you set the seats and the access period, and each student gets their access by email without anyone sending it by hand.
elearningfacil.com/alquila-moodle-por-aulas-plugin

Bulk Certificate Manager

Issue and download a course's certificates in one go (Workplace and Custom certificate), with filters for who qualifies, and keep a record of delivery.

Training Evidence: Time Clock (free)

Measures each student's real active time in the course. It is the way in: if you install the Pack later, everything measured is kept.

Find out more

They all work the same way, together or on their own. You can see them, try them and request them at **elearningfacil.com** · **info@elearningfacil.com**.

13 Frequently asked questions

Can I choose who receives what?

You choose **which alerts are active** in the course: each one notifies the tutor and the student (milestones go to the student only). The tutor's digest email is sent whenever there are problem alerts that day, with or without messages to students.

Can the student reply to the message?

Yes: it is a real Moodle message from the tutor. The conversation continues in normal messaging.

Why did no alert arrive today?

Check that the plugin is enabled in the course, that the daily task has already run (6:00 by default) and that there are students who meet the conditions. The log (§8) is the first place to look.

Does this replace the tutor?

No: it takes the mechanical monitoring off their hands. The automatic message opens the door; the real tutoring is still theirs.

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